

UNIT QUESTION

Was the 2026 Iran War mainly the result of recent decisions, or decades of unresolved conflict?

Type your notes in the boxes, in your own words. Save, then submit the saved PDF in Canvas. The version you submit is the version you may use on the test. One page only.

01 The War Now

2026

KNOW

- Strait of Hormuz
- Proxy vs. armed partner
- Hezbollah · Houthis
- IRGC
- Deterrence

CONNECTION

Today's war → a relationship that needs a history

MY NOTES

Who and where matter most in the current war?

02 The Road to War

FRONTLINE

KNOW

- A documentary is a sourced interpretation
- Immediate trigger vs. historical cause
- Security dilemma
- Nuclear program

CONNECTION

The day fighting began ≠ the day the conflict began

MY NOTES

What did the film document, and what did it argue?

03 Why the U.S. and Iran Became Enemies

1953 TO 1979

KNOW

- Iran was not a mandate
- Mosaddegh · oil nationalization
- Operation TPAJAX (Ajax)
- The Shah · SAVAK
- Khomeini · Islamic Revolution
- Hostage crisis · historical memory

CONNECTION

Intervention → alliance → revolution → reaction

MY NOTES

What grievance did each year create, and for whom?

04 Why Fight Far From Home?

1980-1988

KNOW

- Iran-Iraq War: invasion, isolation
- IRGC · Quds Force
- Deterrence vs. power projection
- Asymmetric strategy
- Where "proxy" misleads

CONNECTION

Vulnerability → security lesson → missiles and partners

MY NOTES

Can one strategy look defensive and threatening at once?

05 The Nuclear Bargain

1957-2018

KNOW

- 1957: the U.S. helps start it
- Enrichment · IAEA · verification
- JCPOA (2015): limits and monitoring for sanctions relief
- 2018 U.S. withdrawal

CONNECTION

Withdrawal → sanctions → less compliance → more pressure

MY NOTES

What did the deal solve, and what did it leave out?

06 From Shadow War to Open War

2023-2026

KNOW

- Shadow war
- 2024: first direct Iran-Israel attacks
- 2025 war · U.S. strikes
- Feb. 28, 2026 offensive
- Threshold · precedent · path dependence

CONNECTION

Size of an attack vs. the precedent it sets

MY NOTES

When did full-scale war become most likely?

07 The Hormuz Lever

1980S + 2026

KNOW

- Chokepoint
- Tanker War · Operation Earnest Will (1987)
- EIA: 21.6M → 4.9M barrels per day
- Military, economic, or diplomatic leverage

CONNECTION

Narrow route → disrupted shipping → global consequences

MY NOTES

What do the numbers prove, and what do they not?

08 Back to the Headline

THIS WEEK

KNOW

- Turning point
- Causal mechanism
- Explanatory beginning vs. immediate trigger
- Counterargument

CONNECTION

This week's news detail → the turning point behind it

MY NOTES

One detail from this week's news, and the turning point that explains it.

THE FINAL ARGUMENT Sort the turning points, rank your top three, and answer the other side.

SORT · DECADES OF UNRESOLVED CONFLICT

SORT · RECENT DECISIONS

MY TOP THREE TURNING POINTS

#1

#2

#3

WHY MY #1 EXPLAINS THE MOST

SOMEONE ELSE MIGHT RANK FIRST...

CONNECTIONS I DO NOT WANT TO FORGET